

“That gives me an idea,” Sigurd said. That night, he snuck down to the riverbank, dug a hole, and lay down in it. Next morning, as Fafnir crawled down to reach the river, Sigurd leaped up and thrust his sword into the dragon’s soft underbelly. Fafnir slumped to the ground, dead.

As they roasted Fafnir’s heart, some of the juices ran onto Sigurd’s finger. When he licked the juice off, he was suddenly able to understand birdsong.

“Regin plans to murder you,” a nuthatch twittered. “He wants all that gold for himself.”

So Sigurd killed Regin and took the gold, not realizing its deadly curse now fell on him.

